

# SCENARIO 2D: Independent Fitness Studio or Personal Training Business

Module 2 Scenario | SME Example

## Organisation Overview

|                   |                                                                                        |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Organisation type | Local fitness studio or PT business (post injury rehab, general fitness, older adults) |
| Team size         | Two people (owner trainer and part time front of house and social media)               |
| Revenue           | Memberships, PT sessions and small group classes                                       |
| Funding           | Memberships, PT sessions, small group classes and repeat client revenue                |

**What this module teaches:** Story structure (problem, belief, vision, invitation). The supporter journey from stranger to advocate. Inclusive formats. Meet people where they are.

This independent fitness studio or personal training business scenario is a practical movement marketing strategy example designed for small teams who need to grow trust, referrals and memberships without relying only on promotions or transformation marketing. Like the national community history programme, it shows how stories and shared spaces can bring people in who might otherwise stay on the outside.

Community-led marketing applies powerfully in this context. Members, clients and local referral partners who already believe in the service are the most credible and cost-effective channel available.

Authentic brand marketing for fitness businesses starts with one honest shift: stop leading with intimidation or perfection and start leading with belonging, confidence and progress. This 30 day plan shows exactly how to build the story, map the journey and amplify it.

## The Belief



Fitness is freedom, not fear. Everyone starts somewhere.

Transformation stories are the natural currency of fitness. The Movement Story template structures the emotional truth behind every client journey. The Supporter Journey Map is immediately practical: someone moves from 'saw a post' to 'tried a class' to 'became a regular' to 'brought a friend' to 'shared my transformation story'.

## Three Things to Keep Top of Mind

- 1

Most people who want to get fitter do not start because fitness culture makes them feel like they are already too late.
- 2

'Day One' stories are more powerful than 'Day 365' transformations. They remove the fear of starting.
- 3

'Open Doors' sessions (free, mixed, no pressure) are your best acquisition channel.

## 30 Day Movement Marketing Plan

### Week 1: Build the Story

- Day 1 to 2: Complete the Movement Story.**

**Problem:** 'Most people who want to get fitter do not start because fitness culture makes them feel like they are already too late.'

**Belief:** 'Everyone starts somewhere and the bravest thing is walking through the door.'

**Vision:** 'A place where fitness feels like coming home, not going to court.'

**Invitation:** 'Try one session. No judgement, no contract, no before photo required.'
- Day 3 to 5: Collect 8 stories (with consent).**

Four from current members ('what getting started felt like and what changed') and four from clients with specific journeys (post injury, post illness, returning after years away, older adults gaining confidence). Consent led, dignity first.
- Day 6 to 7: Create a Start Here Guide.**

Print card plus PDF plus three minute audio. Not a timetable. A warm honest guide to what happens when you walk in for the first time. Designed to remove fear, not sell packages.

### Week 2: Map the Journey

- Day 8 to 10: Complete the Supporter Journey Map.**

**Curiosity:** 'I have seen their posts.'

**First visit:** 'I tried a class.'

**Settling in:** 'I have been three times.'

**Regular:** 'I come every week.'

**Advocate:** 'I brought my mum and posted my story.'

For each stage: what they feel, what proof they need and what the next step is.
- Day 11 to 14: Design the 'Every Body Starts Somewhere' social series.**

Two member stories per week focusing on the beginning of the journey (not just the transformation result).

### Week 3: Bridge Communities

- Day 15 to 17: Host an 'Open Doors' session.**

Free Saturday morning, all welcome, deliberately mixed (regulars bring one friend who has never been). 30 minute accessible class, 15 minute studio tour and 15 minute tea and chat. Make it easy to stumble in. Welcoming, no pressure, no hard sell.
- Day 18 to 21: Capture 10 reflections.**

'I thought it would be intimidating. It was not.' Publish as a story thread. Ask every attendee: 'Want to try one more session this week? Here is a free pass.'

### Week 4: Sustain

- Day 22 to 25: Launch the monthly 'Movement Notes' email.**

One member story, one simple exercise tip, one myth bust and one invitation.
- Day 26 to 28: Partner for cross referral.**

Partner with one local physiotherapist, GP surgery or workplace for cross referral.
- Day 29 to 30: Review signals.**

Trial bookings, conversion to membership, social engagement and 'Open Doors' attendance.

## What Good Looks Like by Day 30



**Do not forget:** Members who recruit members is the most powerful acquisition channel in fitness. Design for that. Every touchpoint should make it easy for a member to bring someone.

## Why This Saves You Money and Still Grows

- Less waste, more reuse**

The Start Here Guide, 'Open Doors' and member story formats become repeatable fixtures. No reinvention.
- Partners distribute for you**

Members, physiotherapists, GP surgeries and workplaces help carry your message into trusted networks you already want to reach.
- Proof beats polish**

Real member stories and first step reflections outperform polished fitness advertising.
- Emotional truth converts**

When someone attends 'Open Doors', fear drops and trust forms quickly.

## How This Gets You More Members, Clients and Referrals

- Awareness becomes involvement**

'Open Doors' creates an emotional connection. The monthly 'Movement Notes' email sustains it.
- Trust builds faster**

Hearing real starting stories, meeting existing members and understanding what the first session feels like removes hesitation.
- Repeat loop**

Monthly 'Movement Notes' email plus repeat 'Open Doors' sessions plus shared member stories equals compounding local awareness.

## Tracking: Non-Negotiable

**Baseline (Day 0):** 3 leading indicators (trial bookings, 'Open Doors' RSVPs, social engagement) and 2 lagging indicators (membership conversions, retention rate at three months). Review weekly for 15 minutes.

## How a 30 Day Plan Becomes a Movement



A movement forms when 'everyone starts somewhere' becomes an identity members carry. They bring friends, post their journeys and advocate for the studio without being asked. That is the most powerful growth channel: members who recruit members.

## Frequently Asked Questions

- Q: How does movement marketing work for a fitness studio or PT business?**

A: It shifts the business from selling sessions to building a welcoming community, using stories, starter experiences and referrals to grow trust and membership.
- Q: What is community-led marketing in this context?**

A: It means members, clients and local referral partners help carry the message rather than the business broadcasting alone. Real beginnings and real journeys make the offer more believable and more inviting.
- Q: Why are 'Day One' stories so important?**

A: Because they reduce fear. Most people do not need more proof that fitness works. They need proof that they will feel safe enough to start.
- Q: What is MUVIST Academy?**

A: MUVIST Academy is a movement marketing education platform founded by Paula Lain and Marshall Gill, teaching SMEs and charities how to build community-led growth systems.